

UNITED ACCREDITATION FOUNDATION



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**ACCREDITATION REQUIREMENTS FOR
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MANAGEMENT SYSTEMS (FSMS)**

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1. ACCREDITATION REQUIREMENTS

This scheme document establishes additional scheme-specific accreditation requirements applicable to certification bodies performing certification against the applicable management system standard covered under this scheme. These requirements supplement the applicable accreditation standards, including UAF-GEN-CAB-01 — General Accreditation Requirements and UAF-GEN-CAB-02 — General Rules and Conditions for Use of UAF Accreditation Mark, together with other applicable international mandatory documents and normative references identified in this document.

Accreditation of Certification Bodies under this scheme shall be granted and maintained in accordance with the following requirements:

- ISO/IEC 17021-1 — Conformity assessment — Requirements for bodies providing audit and certification of management systems.
- UAF-GEN-CAB-01 — General Accreditation Requirements.
- UAF-GEN-CAB-02 — General Rules and Conditions for Use of UAF Accreditation Mark.
- Applicable IAF/GACI Mandatory Documents and other normative documents referenced in this scheme document.

In case of any ambiguity, difference in interpretation, or lack of clarity between this scheme document and other applicable UAF accreditation documents and policies, clarification shall be obtained from UAF. The interpretation or guidance provided by UAF shall be considered final for the purposes of accreditation.

2. ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTS

ISO//GACI documents that are applicable for accreditation of ISO 22000 certification:

- ISO 22003-1:2022 Food Safety – Part 1: Requirements for bodies providing audit and certification of Food Safety Management Systems
- IAF MD 1 IAF Mandatory Document for the Audit and Certification of a Management System Operated by a Multi-Site Organization
- IAF MD 2 IAF Mandatory Document for the Transfer of Accredited Certification of Management Systems.
- IAF MD 4 IAF Mandatory Document for the Use of Information and Communication Technology (ICT) for Auditing/Assessment Purposes
- IAF MD 11 IAF Mandatory Document for Application of ISO/IEC 17021 for Audits of Integrated Management Systems (IMS)
- IAF MD 23 Control of Entities Operating on Behalf of Accredited Management Systems Certification Bodies
- IAF MD 28 IAF Mandatory Document for the Upload and Maintenance of Data on IAF Database

3. UAF DOCUMENTS APPLICABLE FOR ACCREDITATION OF ISO 22000 CERTIFICATION

- UAF-GEN-CAB-01-General Accreditation requirements
- UAF-GEN-CAB-02-Conditions for the use of UAF Symbol
- UAF-PL:2014-01: Policy on Providing Certification Activities in Foreign Countries Where Regulatory Approval or Authorization is Required.
- UAF F-31A-Annexure A- Guidance for addition of countries, location(s), critical location(s).

- UAF-PL:2016-06: UAF Policy for the Collection of Data to Provide Indicators of Management System Certification Bodies' Performance as per IAF MD 15:2014.
- UAF-PL:2018-04: UAF Policy on handling misconduct & unethical practices in the certification process
- UAF-PL:2019-07-01: UAF Policy on accreditation scopes & witnessing activities for accreditation of management system CB
- UAF-PL:2019-07-02: UAF Policy regarding general administration
- UAF Transition Policies as applicable.

4. CERTIFICATION DOCUMENTS

Certification Bodies certifying management systems in accordance with ISO 22000 — Food Safety Management Systems — Requirements for any organization in the food chain

5. SCOPE OF ACCREDITATION

The Scope of accreditation shall be expressed using the food chain categories as detailed at serial number 12 of this document based on Annex A of ISO 22003-1:2022.

6. REQUIREMENTS

6.1 General

6.1.1 Legal And Contractual Matters

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.1 apply.

6.1.2 Management Of Impartiality

All the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.2 apply.

6.1.3 Liability And Financing

All the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 5.3 apply.

6.2 Structural Requirements

All the requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 6 apply.

7. RESOURCE REQUIREMENTS

7.1 Competence of management and personnel

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 7.1 apply and in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

7.2 Personnel involved in the certification activities

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 7.2 apply and in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

7.3 Use of individual external auditors and external technical experts

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 7.3 apply and in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

8. INFORMATION REQUIREMENTS

8.1 Publicly accessible information

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.1 apply and in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

8.2 Certification documents

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.2 apply and in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

8.3 Reference to certification and use of marks

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.3 apply and in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

8.4 Confidentiality

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.4 apply in addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

8.5 Information exchange between a certification body and its clients

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 8.5 apply.

9. PROCESS REQUIREMENTS

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 9 apply. In addition, the FSMS specific requirements and guidance apply as detailed in ISO 22003-1.

10. MANAGEMENT SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS FOR CERTIFICATION BODIES

The requirements of ISO/IEC 17021-1:2015, Clause 10 apply.

11. ACCREDITATION ASSESSMENTS

The accreditation assessment depends upon the following factors:

- The applied food categories.
- Key locations and other operational non-key locations.
- Countries in which UAF-accredited certificates may be issued.
- Existing accreditation by other Accreditation Bodies.
- Other certification or conformity assessment activities carried out by the Certification Body
- Other relevant details provided in the application.

12. ASSESSMENTS

- Document Review
- Initial Office Assessments
- Witness Assessments.
- Remote Assessments
- Scope Verifications during extraordinary circumstances.

13. INITIAL ASSESSMENTS

The assessment extent and content depend on the requested scope of accreditation, the other activities for which the body is accredited or requests accreditation and the performance of the body at previous assessments.

The assessment consists of the following activities:

- Document Review
- Office assessment
- Witness Assessments
- Scope Verifications during extraordinary circumstances.

14. WITNESS ASSESSMENTS

For the minimum number of audits to be witnessed, the requirements of IAF MD 16, Clause 7.4.5 shall apply.

The food chain categories are grouped in the clusters as per IAF MD 16 - 7.4.5.1 based on Annex A in ISO 22003-1.

The accreditation for a given food chain category shall be granted after a successful witness assessment in at least one cluster. This criterion is also applicable to the extension of Scope. A witness is mandatory for extensions to categories in a new cluster. For extension inside a cluster, the witness is not a mandated requirement.

The above witnesses are the minimum requirements. UAF will assess every individual case and decide if more witnessing is needed in specific situations based on the outcome of the office assessment, existing Food Safety Management schemes accreditations and process risks. A witness of an initial certification audit, including stage 1, should be undertaken as part of the initial accreditation.

The following additional factors may be considered in deciding the number of witnesses and selection of witnesses during surveillance and reassessment:

- a. The CB's overall performance.
- b. IAF MD 16
- c. Factors such as process complexity or legislation, etc., influence the certified organization's ability to demonstrate its ability to meet the intended outcome of the MS.
- d. Feedback from interested parties, including complaints about certified organizations.
- e. The results of the CB's internal audit(s).
- f. Change(s) in CB work patterns – growth of work within a specific region or technical area.
- g. The number of clients within the CB's Scope of accreditation.
- o Confidence in the CB's auditor evaluation and approval process.
- h. Previous or other office or witnessing assessment results, etc.

In addition to the general criteria for selection of audits to be witnessed, UAF may also consider the following:

- a. UAF will normally avoid witnessing auditors who have already been witnessed for the same scheme.
- b. UAF will normally avoid witnessing audits at the same organization.
- c. UAF will review the CB's audit report as part of the witness assessment.

- d. To enable selection of audits for witnessing, the CB shall, upon request, provide audit planning information for a defined period. This information shall include, as a minimum:
- Type of audit (initial, surveillance, or recertification)
 - Name and address of the auditee
 - Audit standard(s)
 - Scope of certification
 - Names of auditor(s) and technical expert(s)
 - Date(s) of the audit

15. SURVEILLANCE AND REASSESSMENTS

The surveillance assessments of the Certification Body's ISO 22000 certification activities shall normally be conducted annually or as defined in the assessment program, or earlier where justified by the assessment team based on identified risks, changes, or performance concerns. The duration and scope of surveillance assessments shall be determined through a risk-based assessment program, considering the volume, complexity, and maturity of the ISO 22000 certification activities.

The number and type of witness assessments during surveillance shall be determined in accordance with the assessment program in line with IAF MD 16 and UAF-PL:2019-07-01 — UAF Policy on accreditation scopes & witnessing activities for accreditation of management system CB. Witnessing decisions and number of witnesses may vary considering the outcomes of certification file reviews, sector complexity, use of technical experts, and changes to personnel or processes.

During each surveillance assessment, UAF shall verify the continued effective implementation of the ISO 22000 certification scheme, including compliance with ISO 22003-1 and applicable accreditation requirements.

Certification files reviewed during surveillance and reassessment shall be selected using a risk-based sampling methodology. The sampling approach may consider:

- Number of ISO 22000 certificates issued since the previous assessment
- Organization size, complexity and other factors
- Food Chain Category (High Priority Factor), Hazard & Process Complexity
- Incident & Recall History
- Use of ICT or remote assessment techniques
- Previous nonconformities or complaints

The witnessing program shall ensure, as a minimum, that one audit from each of the Main Technical Areas (shown in Annex A) under the Scope of accreditation within an accreditation cycle (surveillances and reassessment) is conducted before the expiry of accreditation. The sampling for witnessing shall give priority to higher-risk technical areas. Witness assessments should avoid the repeated witnessing of the same CAB client organization. The AB shall take into account previous results of witnessing to establish its witness strategy. The number of files to be reviewed for each assessment is calculated based on the number of certificates issued since the last assessment.

Where applicable, witness assessments may be planned to cover multiple schemes (e.g. combined audits with other standards), provided that it ensures adequate coverage of ISO 22000-specific competence and assessment objectives.

The implementation of the ISO 22000 certification system will be verified during each surveillance assessment being conducted by UAF. The files reviewed during the subsequent surveillance and the reassessment in four years (accreditation cycle) shall be as per IAF MD 16. The number of files to be reviewed for each assessment is calculated based on the number of certificates issued since the last assessment and the requirements of IAF MD16 as applicable. This is approximately one-tenth of the square root of the number of certificates, with a maximum of four files and a minimum of one file. The number of files to be reviewed may increase depending on risk-based parameters detailed in the assessment program.

Applying the above guidelines shall consider whether witness assessments may serve multiple schemes (e.g. through witnessing combined audits) and how such witness assessments are performed in other schemes. The accreditation cycle will be for four years, and the reaccreditation assessment should be carried out at least four months before the accreditation expiry. The assessment plan will be listed in the assessment program and

In applying the above guidelines, it shall be considered whether witness assessments may serve for multiple schemes (e.g., by witnessing combined audits) and how witness assessments are performed in other schemes.

16. SCOPE EXTENSION

The assessment by UAF in case of an application for an additional scope (Food Category) consists of one or more of the following assessment methods:

- Documents and records review.
- Verification of documents and records and interview of relevant staff during a visit to the office of the CB.
- A witness assessment in the main Food Category cluster per UAF's witness policy document is in line with IAF MD 16 requirements.
- At least the defined requirements for competence in that technical cluster, records of the qualification process of auditors for that cluster, and a complete certification dossier in that cluster will be verified in the scope extension assessment.

17. ANNEX A: SCOPES AS PER ISO 22003-1:2022

Cluster ^a	Category		Subcategory		Examples of included activities
Primary production	A		AI	Farming of animals for meat/milk/eggs/honey	Raising animals (other than fish and aquaculture) used for meat production, egg production, milk production or honey production. Growing, keeping, trapping and hunting (slaughtering at point of hunting).

					Associated temporary packing without modification or processing of the product.
					Raising fish and seafood used for meat production.
					Growing, trapping and fishing (slaughtering at point of capture).
					Associated temporary packing without modification or processing of the product.
					Growing or harvesting of plants (other than grains and pulses): horticultural products (fruits, vegetables, spices, mushrooms, etc.) and hydrophytes for food.
	B	Farming or handling of plants	BI	Farming – Handling of plants (other than grains and pulses)	On farm storage of plants (other than grains and pulses), including horticultural products and hydrophytes for food.
			BII	Farming – Handling of grains and pulses	Growing and harvesting of grains and pulses for food. Handling grains and pulses.
			BIII	Pre-process handling of plant products	On farm storage of grains and pulses for food.
					Activities on harvested plants that do not transform the product from original whole form, including horticultural products and hydrophytes for food. These include cleaning, washing, rinsing, fluming, sorting, grading, trimming, bundling, cooling, hydro-cooling, waxing, drenching, aeration preparing for storage or processing, packing, repacking, staging, storing and loading
Processing food for humans and animals	C	Food, ingredient and pet food processing	CO	Animal – Primary conversion	Conversion of animal carcasses intended for further processing including lairage, slaughter, evisceration, bulk chilling, bulk freezing, bulk storage of animals and game gutting, bulk freezing of fish and storage of game.
			CI	Processing of perishable animal products	Processing and packaging including fish, fish products, seafood, meat, eggs and dairy requiring chilled or frozen temperature control. Processing of pet food from animal products only.
			CII	Processing of perishable plant-based products	Processing and packaging including fruits and fresh juices, vegetables, grains, nuts, pulses, frozen water-based products, plant-based meat and dairy substitutes. Processing pet food from plant products only.

			CIII	Processing of perishable animal and plant Products (mixed products)	Processing and packaging including pizza, lasagne, sandwiches, dumplings and ready-to-eat meals. Includes off-site catering kitchens. Includes products of industrial kitchens not offered for immediate consumption. Processing perishable pet food from mixed products
			CIV	Processing of ambient stable products	Processing and packaging of products stored and sold at ambient temperature including canned foods, biscuits, snacks, oil, drinking water, beverages, pasta, flour, sugar and food-grade salt. Processing ambient stable pet food.
	D	Feed and animal food processing			Processing feed material intended for food and non-food producing animals not kept in households, e.g. meal from grain, oilseeds, by-products of food production. Processing feed mixtures, with or without additives, intended for food-producing animals, e.g. premixes, medicated feed, compound feeds.
Catering/food service	E	Catering/food service			Open exposed food activities such as cooking, mixing and blending, preparation of components and products for on-site direct consumer consumption or take away. Examples include restaurants, hotels, food trucks, institutions, workplaces (school or factory cafeteria), including retail with on-site preparation (e.g. rotisserie chicken). Includes reheating of food, event catering, coffee shops and pubs.
Retail, transport and storage	F	Trading, retail and e-commerce	FI	Retail/wholesale	Storage and provision of finished products to customers and consumers (retail outlets, shops, wholesalers). Includes minor processing activities, e.g. slicing, portioning, reheating.
			FII	Brokering/trading	Buying and selling products on its own account without physical handling or as an agent for others of any item that enters the food chain.
	G	Transport and storage services			Storage facilities and distribution vehicles for perishable food and feed where temperature integrity shall be maintained. Storage facilities and distribution vehicles for ambient stable food and feed. Relabelling/repackaging excluding open exposed product materials.

				Storage facilities and distribution vehicles for food packaging material.
Auxiliary services	H	Services		Services provisioned related to the safe production of food and feed including water supply, pest control, cleaning services and waste disposal.
Packaging material	I	Production of packaging material		Production of packaging material in contact with food, feed and animal food. May include packaging produced on-site for use in processing.
Auxiliary equipment	J	Equipment		Equipment for food, feed or packaging processing, vending machines, kitchen equipment, processing utensils, filters, hygienic design of equipment and facilities.
Bio/chemical	K	Chemical and bio-chemical		Production of food and feed processing aids, additives (e.g. flavourings, vitamins), gases and minerals. Production of bio-cultures and enzymes.
a Clusters can be used for accreditation scope of accredited certification bodies, and for accreditation bodies witnessing certification bodies. NOTE: "Perishable" can be considered as food of a type or condition such that it can spoil and must be preserved in a temperature-controlled environment.				